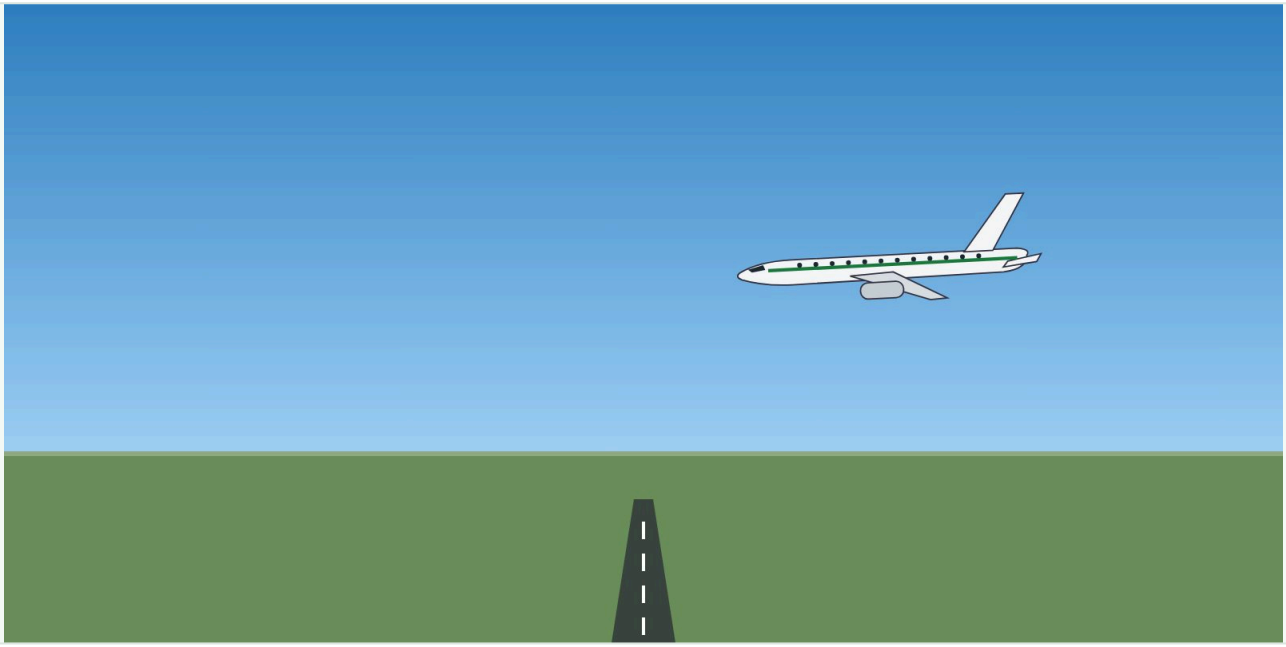
MODULE 1 · APPROACH OPERATIONS

Lesson 03: Planning Minima and the Approach Ban

Lesson 3 of 4 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Apply planning minima for destination and alternates.
- Apply the approach ban rule.
- Make the go-around decision at the minimum.



Approach ban: 1,000 ft above the aerodrome.

Planning

At the planning stage, the weather at the destination and the alternates must be at or above the **planning minima** for the expected time of use (often with a time window before and after the ETA). Planning minima for alternates are higher than the landing minima — the values are in OM A (based on CAT.OP.MPA.185 / 245).

The approach ban

APPROACH BAN (EASA CAT.OP.MPA.305)

The commander shall not continue an approach **below 1,000 ft above the aerodrome** (or into the final approach segment) if the reported RVR or visibility is **less than the applicable minimum**. If it falls below the minimum after passing 1,000 ft, the approach may be continued to the DA/H or MDA/H.

At the minimum

- Continue below the DA/H or MDA/H only if the **required visual reference** is established and can be maintained — for example elements of the approach lights, the threshold, the touchdown zone or their lights.
- Otherwise, go around — and fly the published missed approach.
- If visual reference is lost below the minimum, go around immediately.

COMPANY AUTHORISATION

The approach operations each fleet is authorised for — for example CAT I only, or CAT II for a fleet and crew with the approval — are listed in the **AOC operations specifications** issued by the **DACM**. The method and values for minima are in **OM A**; the aerodrome minima are in **OM C** and the charts.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Plan with planning minima (higher than landing minima) for destination and alternates.
- Approach ban: no continuing below 1,000 ft if reported RVR / VIS is below minima.
- Below DA/MDA only with the required visual reference.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

At 1,500 ft above the aerodrome, the reported RVR drops below your minimum. What applies?

A. Continue to the DA anyway

B. The approach ban: do not continue below 1,000 ft above the aerodrome

C. Land without reference

D. Request CAT III

Answer: B. Below 1,000 ft the approach may not be continued if the reported RVR is below the minimum.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.